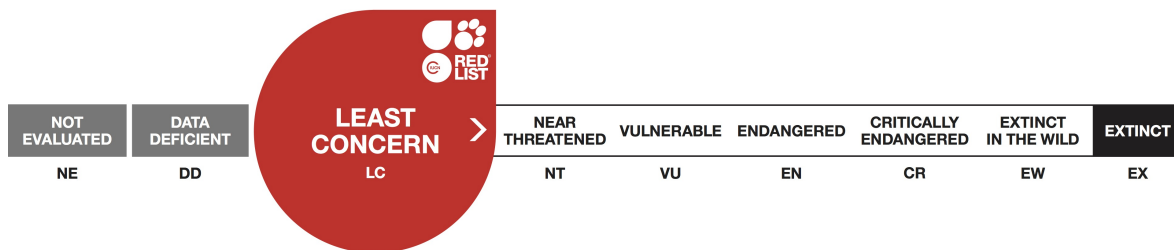


Dinomys branickii, Pacarana

Assessment by: Roach, N.



View on www.iucnredlist.org

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Mammalia	Rodentia	Dinomyidae

Taxon Name: *Dinomys branickii* Peters, 1873

Common Name(s):

- English: Pacarana

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Least Concern [ver 3.1](#)

Year Published: 2017

Date Assessed: March 1, 2016

Justification:

This species is listed as Least Concern because it has a wide-ranging distribution, occurs in protected areas, and is unlikely to be declining at a rate which would merit a threatened listing. Further information about this species ecology and habitat use is needed to better understand its vulnerability to threats and species extinction risk.

Previously Published Red List Assessments

2008 – Vulnerable (VU)

<http://dx.doi.org/10.2305/IUCN.UK.2008.RLTS.T6608A12790614.en>

1996 – Endangered (EN)

1994 – Endangered (E)

1990 – Endangered (E)

Geographic Range

Range Description:

This species is known from the Merida Andes of northwestern Venezuela, all three Andean cordilleras in Colombia, south along both Andean slopes of Ecuador, the eastern Andean slope and western Amazon Basin of Peru and Bolivia, and western Brazil (Patton 2015). The elevation range is approximately 250-3,200 m spanning western margins of lowland Amazonian rainforest to upper montane tropical forest on the Andean slopes (Patton 2015). There have been two new records in Colombia, extending the distribution by 1,500 m in the Andes slopes and lowlands of the Choco Biogeographico of Colombia (Saavedra-Rodriguez *et al.* 2012, Patton 2015).

Country Occurrence:

Native: Bolivia, Plurinational States of; Brazil; Colombia; Ecuador; Peru; Venezuela, Bolivarian Republic

of

Distribution Map

Dinomys branickii

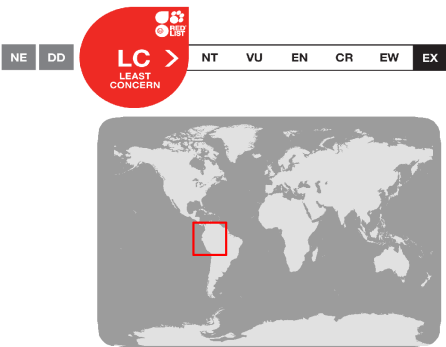


Range

Extant (resident)

Compiled by:

IUCN SSC Small Mammal Specialist Group



Population

The species appears to be rare and its distribution is patchy (Lord 1999). In Bolivia, the species appears to be rare in general; however, it appears to be common in Cotapata National Park (J. Vargas pers. comm.). The most extensive population density study estimated 5.5-9.9 groups per km² (Saavedra-Rodriguez *et al.* 2012; Patton 2015). There are no current population estimates (Saavedra-Rodriguez pers. comm.).

Current Population Trend: Unknown

Habitat and Ecology (see Appendix for additional information)

Most specimens have come from upland rainforest of the Andes or outlier ridges (Grimwood 1969). Little is known about the wild habits of this species, but in captivity it is tame. Claws indicate it to be a digger. It appears to be easy to capture for both predator and man. It is active by night, resting in caves or dens at the base of trees. This rodent has some climbing ability, especially prominent in young animals. It feeds on fruits, leaves, and plant shoots. It produces a wide variety of vocalizations, and males seeking mates produce a complicated, intricate series of calls. Gestation lies between 222 and 280 days; generally only two young are born (Eisenberg 1974, Eisenberg and Redford 1999, Lord 1999). Preferred habitat is seasonally flooded tropical evergreen rainforest, and it occurs limitedly along the Amazonian margins of the species range (Patton 2015). Nests in rock crevices, hollow logs, or self-dug burrows either solitarily or in groups of 2-5 (Saavedra-Rodriguez *et al.* 2012, Patton 2015). While species can live in forest fragments the limiting factor of abundance and distribution is adequate dens (Patton 2015).

Systems: Terrestrial

Threats (see Appendix for additional information)

The major threats are deforestation and habitat loss. As an agricultural pest this species is hunted and consumed especially in cultivated areas. Domestic dogs also predate on the species (Saavedra-Rodriguez pers. comm.). Alves and Brito 2013 list the species as vulnerable on a global scale and argues it should be conserved.

Conservation Actions (see Appendix for additional information)

There are records in several protected areas.

Credits

Assessor(s): Roach, N.

Reviewer(s): Amori, G.

Contributor(s): Dunnum, J., Tirira, D.G. & Vargas, J.

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External Resources

For [Images and External Links to Additional Information](#), please see the [Red List website](#).

Appendix

Habitats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
1. Forest -> 1.6. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Moist Lowland	-	Suitable	-
1. Forest -> 1.9. Forest - Subtropical/Tropical Moist Montane	-	Suitable	-
4. Grassland -> 4.7. Grassland - Subtropical/Tropical High Altitude	-	Suitable	-

Threats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Threat	Timing	Scope	Severity	Impact Score
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.3. Livestock farming & ranching -> 2.3.4. Scale Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.1. Intentional use (species is the target)	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.3. Persecution/control	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		

Conservation Actions in Place

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Actions in Place
In-Place Land/Water Protection and Management
Occur in at least one PA: Yes

Additional Data Fields

Distribution
Lower elevation limit (m): 250
Upper elevation limit (m): 3200

Population
Population severely fragmented: No

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